

A natural writer

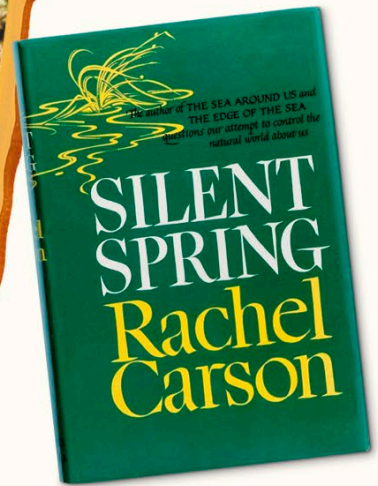
Rachel combined her biology education with her love for writing and nature. As a wildlife editor for the government, she wrote radio programs about sea life. She also wrote many magazine articles and books of her own. These used a very different style of writing from other science books, blending poetic language and science in a way that made people care deeply about the natural world.

Rachel's research and books show how humans are also a part of nature. They tell of how science has helped us to discover the wonders of nature, but also warn of the damage humans can do to ecosystems. Rachel's work changed attitudes so much that it led to new laws, and even a brand-new government agency tasked with protecting the environment.



*Rachel's first books focused on the seashore, the part of nature she loved the best. Her book *The Sea Around Us* was made into an award-winning movie.*

*Her book *Silent Spring* made people realize that it is important to look after the environment.*



DDT damage

Rachel was worried about the use of strong chemicals, such as dichlorodiphenyltrichloroethane (DDT for short!), to kill insect pests. These chemicals were also bad for other wildlife. Rachel helped to alert the world to the dangers of DDT, and eight years after she died, it was banned in the US.



Ibis bird eggs damaged by DDT

As a trainee scientist, Rachel studied the life of catfish.



Catfish

American eel

